Linux `hostnamectl` Command Notes

The `hostnamectl` command is used to **view and change the system's hostname** and related settings on Linux systems that use `systemd`.

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1. Show Hostname Information

```
hostnamectl
```

Description: Displays the current hostname and related system details.

Example Output:

```
   Static hostname: prashant-laptop
         Icon name: computer-laptop
           Chassis: laptop
        Machine ID: abcd1234efgh5678
           Boot ID: 9876abcd5432efgh
  Operating System: Ubuntu 22.04 LTS
            Kernel: Linux 5.15.0-58-generic
      Architecture: x86-64
```

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2. Set a Static Hostname

```
sudo hostnamectl set-hostname newname
```

Description: Changes the system's static hostname permanently.

Example:

```
sudo hostnamectl set-hostname myserver
```

After running, the prompt and hostname will update.

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3. Show Only the Hostname

```
hostnamectl --static
```

Description: Shows only the static hostname.

Example:

```
myserver
```

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4. Show Transient Hostname

```
hostnamectl --transient
```

Description: Shows the temporary hostname (set at runtime, may reset after reboot).

Example:

```
mytemp-host
```

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5. Show Pretty Hostname

```
hostnamectl --pretty
```

Description: Shows a descriptive, user-friendly hostname if set.

Example:

```
Prashant’s Workstation
```

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6. Use Cases

- Checking system hostname and OS info.
- Changing hostname for easier identification on a network.
- Viewing architecture and kernel version.
- System administration in multi-server environments.

Quick Summary

Option	Meaning	Example Command
`hostnamectl`	Show all hostname/system info	`hostnamectl`
`set-hostname`	Set a new static hostname	`sudo hostnamectl set-hostname myserver`
`--static`	Show static hostname	`hostnamectl --static`
`--transient`	Show temporary hostname	`hostnamectl --transient`
`--pretty`	Show pretty (descriptive) hostname	`hostnamectl --pretty`

✅ `hostnamectl` is the modern replacement for `hostname` when managing hostnames on **systemd-based Linux systems** (like Ubuntu, CentOS, Fedora, Debian).